

Bentley Systems

The infrastructure engineering software company — design, construction and operations · www.bentley.com

1984

Founded

~5,500–5,800

Employees

\$1.5B (FY2025)

Revenue (latest/est.)

Public

Ownership

3.9/5

Glassdoor (1,424)

Yes

Digital twin

01 Overview

Profitable, public infrastructure-software incumbent with a 40-year design-through-operations footprint — the closest thing to an “establishment” peer for Sand’s water/energy/transport verticals, and the best-rated employer on this list by its own staff.

Offering: iTwin Platform (infrastructure digital twins), AssetWise (asset/network performance), ProjectWise (project delivery), SYNCHRO (construction management) and MicroStation-based design tools; 41,000+ accounts in ~195 countries.

Key facts

HQ: Exton, PA

Ownership: Public (Nasdaq: BSY); Bentley family retains majority voting control via dual-class shares

Revenue: \$1.5B (FY2025), up 11% YoY; 24.1% operating margin

Web: www.bentley.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Nicholas Cumins (Chief Executive Officer) · Greg Bentley (Executive Chairman (co-founder))

Digital twin: Yes (iTwin is a core platform) · **GenAI:** Emerging (AI features layered into iTwin/AssetWise)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
Rail / transit	WSP — Melbourne rail network project using ProjectWise, SYNCHRO & iTwin	Modeling time reduced 60%, productivity increased 25%, carbon footprint reduced 30%	Link
Water utilities	Singapore’s national water agency (PUB) — digital twin + AI leak detection	Near-real-time detection and localization of water-supply anomalies and leaks via high-fidelity digital twin and hydraulic modeling	Link
Bridges / dams	AssetWise bridge & dam monitoring — drone + iTwin Capture digital twins	Converts physical inspections into remote, AI/ML-assisted defect detection, avoiding costly and hazardous site visits	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Sand Technologies · Palantir Technologies · C3.ai · Cognite · AVEVA · IBM watsonx · Honeywell Forge · Siemens Xcelerator

Where it sits: Strong overlap with Sand on infrastructure asset lifecycle and digital twins, but Bentley’s roots are in engineering design software (CAD-first) rather than real-time operational AI control.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock’s dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No named GIP portfolio company was confirmed as a Bentley customer, though Bentley’s customer base of government transportation agencies and infrastructure owner-operators plausibly overlaps with GIP-owned airports, ports and rail (Bentley’s software is near-ubiquitous in civil infrastructure...
BlackRock	Confirmed — 5.4% of shares outstanding per a July 2026 Schedule 13G/A, making BlackRock Bentley’s largest institutional holder outside the founding Bentley family, which retains majority voting control via dual-class...

05 Sentiment

Customer: Deep bench of quantified, named case studies (WSP, Singapore PUB) published directly by Bentley, plus a large installed base that generates steady independent commentary in AEC industry press — among the more substantively evidenced customer track records on this list.

What supports the story

- Best employee sentiment on this list: 3.9/5 Glassdoor, 76% recommend, 88% CEO approval
- Profitable at scale — 24.1% operating margin, \$538M operating cash flow in FY2025
- 41,000+ accounts across 194 countries gives it the broadest installed base of any name here

What to pressure-test

- AI narrative is “emerging,” not core — lags Palantir/C3.ai/Cognite on generative and agentic AI maturity
- Dual-class share structure keeps the founding family in control, limiting activist or outside investor influence
- CAD/engineering-design heritage means real-time operational AI control is a newer, less-proven muscle than for Sand or Cognite

Employee: Consistently positive: strong culture and work-life balance are the most-cited pros; below-market pay in some regions and a perceived “slow transformation” pace are the most-cited cons.

Sources: Bentley Systems public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked “est.” or “not disclosed” are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.